



The TARSHI helplines received 59,000 calls from men asking about the '*suhaag raat*' and how to make their wives happy.



INDIA TOPS THE GLOBAL CHARTS OF PEOPLE SEARCHING UP "SEX", SAYS GOOGLE.



AIIMS records find people into multiple partners, paid sex or same-sex relationships to gain sexual 'experience'.

behind whose repeated complaints about his sex-life lay his utter ignorance about the female body. "Although we get hundreds of calls and mails on the whys and hows of contraceptives, yet it is obvious that people are experimenting with their love-lives like never before," he says. Most mails mention multiple partners, paid sex or even using same-sex friends to get 'ini-

tiated' or gain 'experience'.

Statistics show up the reality: In 1996, the Durex-Mode study on contraception in India found that an average male had sex for the first time at the age of 25. In 2005, the same survey found that Indians lost virginity on an average at 19.8 years. The INDIA TODAY sex surveys capture the attitudinal sea change. If in 1978, premarital sex

was "unacceptable" to 75 per cent unmarried metro women, in the new millennium a quarter confess to having regular sex. By 2005, over 69 per cent women wanted as much sex as men.

The paradox is puzzling. India is a far more liberal society than it was a decade ago. It all started in the 1990s when American music videos and television shows, thanks to satellite

"I come across an astounding level of sexual ignorance, discord and disharmony."

DR BIR SINGH, PROFESSOR, AIIMS

